the Deccan, a group of disaffected Jats looted and pillaged the tomb of Akbar, robbing the mausoleum of its precious stones, gold and silver plates, and other valuable objects, and set fire to what they could not remove.

There are far grander monuments to the great Mughal emperors and their consorts, but it is almost fitting that the greatest of them all lies today in relatively austere and reduced splendour, and that his unique capital remains in genteel neglect. For Akbar doesn't need ostentatious memorials to burnish his memory, his extraordinary life is memorial enough. His legacy remains in the supreme courage he displayed, far greater than on any battlefield, in believing that the vast multitudes of India could be brought together through active efforts of tolerance and understanding. That through reason, empathy, and good faith, misunderstandings between different religious groups and ethnicities could be resolved, and a new horizon unveiled. A horizon that could be lit up by the light from many different faiths, the best of each, to guide India's path to a more luminous and resplendent future.

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*He balanced these favours by having life-size statues of Amar Singh and his son Karan Singh on horseback placed below the jharoka window at Agra, a sign of submission.

* Ashoka famously propounded his philosophy of Dhamma through a series of edicts inscribed on rock surfaces. Among other things, these edicts advocated non-violence, respect towards elders, and tolerance amongst sects.

*A sixteenth-century Sufi shaikh of the Shattari order in Gwalior.